

MINISTRIES DEPARTMENTS AND CENTRAL SECRETARIAT

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE → AOB AND TOB: JURISDICTION → INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD → MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE → CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND → CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 repaired in place for answer-line and visual-boundary quality • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN

CONSTITUTIONAL ROOT AND THE OPERATING CHAIN ROOT QUESTION HOW DOES PARLIAMENTARY EXECUTIVE AUTHORITY BECOME ORGANISED GOVERNMENTAL ACTION? ARTICLES 73 + 74 --- UNION EXECUTIVE FIELD AND +-- POLITICAL AUTHORITY REMAINS CONSTITUTION-BOUNDED

ARTICLE 77 -----+-- ACTION IN PRESIDENT'S NAME AND AUTHENTICATION

+-- ARTICLE 77(3) BUSINESS-ALLOCATION AND TRANSACTION RULES

ARTICLE 78 ----- PM COMMUNICATION AND INFORMATION DUTIES TO

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ROOT QUESTION
- How does parliamentary executive authority become organised governmental action?

POWER / PROCEDURE

- ARTICLES 73 + 74 --- Union executive field and ministerial advice
- +-- political authority remains Constitution-bounded

CHECK / LIMIT

- ARTICLE 77 -----+-- action in President's name and authentication
- +-- Article 77(3) business-allocation and transaction rules

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ARTICLE 78 ----- PM communication and information duties to President
- Ministerial direction → Secretariat advice/process → agency delivery → accountability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A ministry joins democratic authority, ministerial responsibility and permanent expertise, while its effectiveness depends on aligning policy, finance, personnel, coordination and accountability.

01

STAGE 01 AOB AND TOB: JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE

AOB AND TOB JURISDICTION BEFORE PROCEDURE ARTICLE 77(3) ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES WHO TRAP RAIL ARTICLE 309 SCHEDULE CAN CHANGE STATUTE STILL CONTROLS.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ARTICLE 77(3)
ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is decided ministry/department +
subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route

POWER / PROCEDURE

TRAP RAIL
AoB != ToB
both != Article 309

CHECK / LIMIT

schedule can change
statute still controls.
ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- ARTICLE 77(3)
- ALLOCATION OF BUSINESS RULES TRANSACTION OF BUSINESS RULES who handles what how a proposal is decided ministry/department +
- subjects disposal + consultation + escalation lawful owner + lawful decision route

POWER / PROCEDURE

- TRAP RAIL
- AoB != ToB
- both != Article 309

CHECK / LIMIT

- schedule can change
- statute still controls.
- ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Allocation supplies jurisdiction; transaction supplies procedure and collective discipline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Articles 74, 75, 77 and 88 connect advice, responsibility, business rules and parliamentary participation, thereby linking Union administration to democratic accountability.

02

STAGE 02 INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY

INSTITUTION MAP POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY SECRETARIAT POLITICAL BROAD ALLOCATED POLICY/LAW/BUDGET CHARGE UNIT SUBJECT UNIT ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE TECHNICAL LEAD EXECUTION/SERVICE TERRITORIAL SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS STATUTORY BODY

AUTONOMOUS BODY

TRAP ADMINISTRATIVE ASSOCIATION DOES NOT ERASE THE SOURCE INSTRUMENT

PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit

ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain

SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body

autonomous body

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory
- ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain

POWER / PROCEDURE

- SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body
- autonomous body

CHECK / LIMIT

- TRAP administrative association does not erase the source instrument or statutory independence.
- PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain
- SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The delivery chain runs from ministerial policy through Secretariat coordination to directorates and field agencies, while feedback and accountability must travel back upward.

02

STAGE 02

INSTITUTION MAP: POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY

INSTITUTION MAP

POLITICAL HEAD TO FIELD DELIVERY

SECRETARIAT POLITICAL BROAD ALLOCATED POLICY/LAW/BUDGET CHARGE UNIT SUBJECT UNIT

ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE TECHNICAL LEAD EXECUTION/SERVICE TERRITORIAL

SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS STATUTORY BODY

AUTONOMOUS BODY

TRAP ADMINISTRATIVE ASSOCIATION DOES NOT ERASE THE SOURCE INSTRUMENT

PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit

ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain → SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body → autonomous body

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory
- ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain

POWER / PROCEDURE

- SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body
- autonomous body

CHECK / LIMIT

- TRAP administrative association does not erase the source instrument or statutory independence.
- PORTFOLIO → MINISTRY → DEPARTMENT → SECRETARIAT political broad allocated policy/law/budget charge unit subject unit coordination/memory

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- ATTACHED OFFICE SUBORDINATE OFFICE FIELD/DIRECTORATE technical lead execution/service territorial chain
- SEPARATE LEGAL FORMS statutory body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The delivery chain runs from ministerial policy through Secretariat coordination to directorates and field agencies, while feedback and accountability must travel back upward.

03

STAGE 03

MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY

MINISTER, MINISTER OF STATE AND SECRETARY

POLITICAL EXECUTIVE

CABINET MINISTER

PORTFOLIO LEADERSHIP, CABINET PARTICIPATION, PARLIAMENT.

MINISTER OF STATE

INDEPENDENT CHARGE OR ASSIGNED ASSISTANCE, AS FORMALLY ALLOCATED.

PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

ADMINISTRATIVE HEAD + PRINCIPAL OFFICIAL ADVISER + TRANSACTION COMPLIANCE.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
POLITICAL EXECUTIVE	Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance.	oral direction	Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.
Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament.	PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation.	short tenure	
Minister of State → independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated.	FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice	hidden responsibility.	
PERMANENT EXECUTIVE	bureaucratic veto	ANSWER STRIP	

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- POLITICAL EXECUTIVE
- Cabinet Minister → portfolio leadership, Cabinet participation, Parliament.
- Minister of State → independent charge or assigned assistance, as formally allocated.
- PERMANENT EXECUTIVE

POWER / PROCEDURE

- Secretary → administrative head + principal official adviser + transaction compliance.
- PRODUCTIVE RELATION elected priority → candid options/legality → recorded decision → loyal implementation.
- FAILURE BRANCHES politicised advice
- bureaucratic veto

CHECK / LIMIT

- oral direction
- short tenure
- hidden responsibility.
- ANSWER STRIP

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- Responsive neutrality joins lawful democratic control to professional institutional memory.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cabinet makes collective political decisions, Cabinet Committees handle delegated political work, and Committees of Secretaries coordinate administration without acquiring ministerial authority.

04

STAGE 04

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT POLICY

FILE RAIL RECEIPT

SECTION EXAMINATION

INTER-DEPARTMENT CONSULTATION

DELEGATED OR HIGHER APPROVAL

SECTION OFFICER

UNDER SECRETARY

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy → FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options → inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval → authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI. → Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

- CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy
- FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options

POWER / PROCEDURE

- inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval
- authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI.

CHECK / LIMIT

- Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director
- Joint Secretary → Additional/Special Secretary → Secretary.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

- TRAP not every file reaches Minister/Secretary; delegation is an accountability design, not evasion.
- CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Central Secretariat is the collective policy-support machinery of Union ministries, not a single building and not a synonym for the Cabinet Secretariat.

05

STAGE 05

CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION

CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION

CABINET SECRETARIAT

CABINET PAPERS/DECISIONS

AOB-TOB ADMINISTRATION

CRISIS AND CONSENSUS.

PMO DIRECT ASSISTANCE TO PRIME MINISTER

PRIORITY REVIEW

MATTERS REQUIRING PM ATTENTION.

Cabinet papers/decisions	AoB-ToB administration	CoS	crisis and consensus.
PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister	priority review	matters requiring PM attention.	

MINISTRIES DEPARTMENTS AND CENTRAL SECRETARIAT • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2238-5472 of 9949 • continues below

04

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT FUNCTIONS AND FILE PROCESS

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy

FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options

inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval

authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI.

Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy

FILE RAIL receipt → section examination → facts/law/finance → noting/options

POWER / PROCEDURE

inter-department consultation → delegated or higher approval

authentication/issue → implementation → monitoring/audit/RTI.

CHECK / LIMIT

Section Officer → Under Secretary → Deputy Secretary/Director

Joint Secretary → Additional/Special Secretary → Secretary.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

TRAP not every file reaches Minister/Secretary; delegation is an accountability design, not evasion.

CENTRAL SECRETARIAT policy

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Central Secretariat is the collective policy-support machinery of Union ministries, not a single building and not a synonym for the Cabinet Secretariat.

05

STAGE 05CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION

CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND COORDINATION

CABINET SECRETARIAT

CABINET PAPERS/DECISIONS

AOB-TOB ADMINISTRATION

CRISIS AND CONSENSUS.

PMO DIRECT ASSISTANCE TO PRIME MINISTER

PRIORITY REVIEW

MATTERS REQUIRING PM ATTENTION.

Cabinet papers/decisions

PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister

Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet

AoB-ToB administration

priority review

PMO != super-ministry

CoS

matters requiring PM attention.

Cabinet Secretary != minister.

crisis and consensus.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

CABINET SECRETARIAT

Cabinet papers/decisions

AoB-ToB administration

crisis and consensus.

POWER / PROCEDURE

PMO direct assistance to Prime Minister

priority review

matters requiring PM attention.

UNRESOLVED DIFFERENCE department consultation → Committee of Secretaries → concerned ministers

CHECK / LIMIT

Cabinet Committee/Cabinet under the prescribed route.

Cabinet Secretariat != Cabinet

PMO != super-ministry

Cabinet Secretary != minister.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

ANSWER STRIP

Central coordination should enable departments without erasing ministerial answerability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Over-centralisation in either can weaken departmental initiative; weak central coordination can produce silos and contradictory policies.

06

STAGE 06AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES

AGENCIES, AUTONOMY AND WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT OUTCOMES

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER ATTACHED/SUBORDINATE OFFICE

TECHNICAL/FIELD EXECUTION AUTONOMOUS BODY

CHARTERED SPECIAL FUNCTION

COMMERCIAL/STRATEGIC OPERATION REGULATOR

STATUTE-BASED ARM'S-LENGTH GOVERNANCE

WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM CLIMATE/DATA/SKILLS/WATER

MANY DEPARTMENTS

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance

WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance

POWER / PROCEDURE

WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

CHECK / LIMIT

LIMIT mission unit or dashboard cannot displace statute, sanction, Cabinet route or audit.

DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance

WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Secretariats primarily formulate and supervise policy while executive agencies deliver it, but delegation never removes departmental stewardship or ministerial accountability.

07

STAGE 07OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE

OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE

ACCOUNTABILITY GRID

POLITICAL AND POLICY SCRUTINY.

FINANCIAL LEGALITY, PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE.

TRANSPARENCY, LEGALITY AND PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY.

2ND ARC PRINCIPLES

COMPETENCY-TO-POST FIT

MISSION KARMAYOGI DIGITAL RECORD

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

ACCOUNTABILITY GRID

Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny.

budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance.

POWER / PROCEDURE

RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.

2nd ARC principles

competency-to-post fit

CHECK / LIMIT

Mission Karmayogi digital record

impact evaluation

stable tenure

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

specialist/lateral support.

Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.

TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

POWER / PROCEDURE

CHECK / LIMIT

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

MINISTRIES DEPARTMENTS AND CENTRAL SECRETARIAT • TILE 3/4 • same master rows 4477-7711 of 9949 • continues below

• DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

• CPSE → commercial/strategic operation regulator → statute-based arm's-length governance

departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

• CORRECTIVE named lead + shared milestones/data + funds/functionaries + State/field feedback.

route or audit.

• DEPARTMENTAL POLICY OWNER attached/subordinate office → technical/field execution autonomous body → chartered special function

governance

• WHOLE-OF-GOVERNMENT PROBLEM climate/data/skills/water → many departments → silo optimisation → outcome failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Secretariats primarily formulate and supervise policy while executive agencies deliver it, but delegation never removes departmental stewardship or ministerial accountability.

07

STAGE 07

OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE

OVERSIGHT, REFORM AND NOTIFICATION-SENSITIVE CHANGE

ACCOUNTABILITY GRID

POLITICAL AND POLICY SCRUTINY.

FINANCIAL LEGALITY, PROPRIETY AND PERFORMANCE.

TRANSPARENCY, LEGALITY AND PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY.

2ND ARC PRINCIPLES

COMPETENCY-TO-POST FIT

MISSION KARMAYOGI DIGITAL RECORD

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ACCOUNTABILITY GRID	RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.	Mission Karmayogi digital record	specialist/lateral support.
Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny.	2nd ARC principles	impact evaluation	Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.
budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance.	competency-to-post fit	stable tenure	TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE

• ACCOUNTABILITY GRID

• Parliament/questions/DRSCs → political and policy scrutiny.

• budget/demands/CAG/PAC → financial legality, propriety and performance.

POWER / PROCEDURE

• RTI/courts/vigilance → transparency, legality and personal responsibility.

• 2nd ARC principles

• competency-to-post fit

CHECK / LIMIT

• Mission Karmayogi digital record

• impact evaluation

• stable tenure

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT

• specialist/lateral support.

• Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.

• TRAP renamed organogram != improved outcome; ministry/committee counts must be dated.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Article 77(3) rule change → cadres/budgets/records/contracts/statutory references transition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Preserve institutional balance: coordination by Cabinet Secretariat/PMO must enable, not erase, ministerial responsibility and departmental expertise.

08

STAGE 08

UPSC SYNTHESIS: ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY

UPSC SYNTHESIS

ORGANISED AUTHORITY WITH TRACEABLE RESPONSIBILITY

PRELIMS FIREWALL

PRESIDENT'S NAME

PERSONAL DECISION

CABINET SECRETARIAT

CABINET COMMITTEE

COMMITTEE OF SECRETARIES ATTACHED OFFICE

PRELIMS FIREWALL

President's name != personal decision

Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat

Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office != autonomous body

regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
PRELIMS FIREWALL President's name != personal decision Secretariat != Cabinet Secretariat	Cabinet Committee != Committee of Secretaries attached office != autonomous body regulator autonomy survives ordinary instruction. MAINS SPINE	Articles 73/74/77/78 → AoB-ToB → ministry/department Minister-Secretary → Secretariat/file → coordination agencies/outcomes → oversight → reform.	PYQ SPINE 2025 organisation-ministry pairs → verify allocated subject and parent law. VERDICT effective machinery aligns functions, funds, functionaries, expertise and answerability.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Executive action is taken in the President's name, but the President does not personally administer each department.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

THE PRINCIPAL DELEGATES AUTHORITY

THE AGENT POSSESSES INFORMATION THE PRINCIPAL MAY LACK

MONITORING IS INCOMPLETE; AND

RESPONSIBILITY CAN BE SHIFTED DOWN OR SIDEWAYS.

ADVERSE SELECTION

APPOINTING AN AGENT WITHOUT KNOWING CAPABILITY/INTEGRITY

MORAL HAZARD

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE

the principal delegates authority;

the agent possesses information the principal may lack;

monitoring is incomplete; and

responsibility can be shifted down or sideways.

ADVANCED LIMIT

adverse selection: appointing an agent without knowing capability/integrity;

moral hazard: agent acts differently after receiving discretion;

information asymmetry: ministry/agency knows more than Parliament/citizen;

multiple principals: an agency answers to ministry, finance, regulator, court and legislature;

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

blame avoidance: success is claimed centrally while failure is attributed to field offices.

Minister states objectives, political priorities and acceptable trade-offs.

Secretary supplies options, legality, evidence, implementation constraints and institutional

Disagreement is recorded professionally.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.